

Warm Quinoa Salad with Roasted Vegetables (Variation 11)

Tags: salad, vegan, gluten-free, healthy, meal-prep | Prep: 15 min | Cook: 30 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 4.5 cups quinoa, rinsed
- 9 cups vegetable stock
- 3 red bell pepper, diced
- 3 yellow bell pepper, diced
- 3 zucchini, diced
- 3 small eggplant, diced
- 3 red onion, cut into wedges
- 9 tbsp olive oil
- 3 tsp smoked paprika
- Salt and black pepper
- 180 g baby spinach
- 90 g toasted pine nuts
- fresh parsley and mint, chopped
- Dressing: 9 tbsp lemon juice, 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil, 1 tsp cumin, salt, pepper

Method

1. Preheat oven to 220 °C.
2. Toss all diced vegetables and onion in olive oil, smoked paprika, salt, and pepper. Spread on 2 large baking trays.
3. Roast for 25–30 minutes, turning once, until golden and slightly charred at the edges.
4. Meanwhile, combine quinoa and stock in a saucepan. Bring to a boil, then cover and simmer for 15 minutes. Remove from heat and rest, covered, for 5 minutes. Fluff with a fork.
5. Whisk together dressing ingredients.
6. In a large bowl, combine warm quinoa, roasted vegetables, and baby spinach. Toss with dressing.
7. Transfer to a platter. Top with pine nuts and fresh herbs.

Chef Tips

- Rinsing quinoa removes the bitter saponin coating — never skip this step.
- The salad is equally good warm or at room temperature, making it excellent for meal prep.
- Add crumbled feta or roasted chickpeas for extra protein.